
■ CORRIDOR METALS

Sales playbook
2026

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Paper Desk — tariff recovery As of 13 Sep

Tariff recovery for exporters: what we sell, who to, and exactly what to say

This is the whole job on paper. A new salesperson should be able to read it in an hour, make the first call the same afternoon, and never say anything we can't back up. Where a number is rough or a rule is still being confirmed, it is marked. Nothing in here is a guarantee to a client.

Status of the rules this playbook relies on: US IEEPA refund process **Verified** CBP guidance, court orders. Canadian surtax relief **Verified** CBSA notices. Who may prepare vs file claims in each country **Unverified** — lawyer confirms before first engagement. Pool sizes and deadline math **Rough** — estimates, confirmed per client in ACE.

1. The offer in one breath

Between February 2025 and February 2026 a lot of Canadian companies paid 25–35% US tariffs that the Supreme Court has since thrown out. If you paid them, or your US customers paid them on your goods, that money is refundable with interest — but only if someone files, and some deadlines are already closing. We find out what you're owed, do the work, and get paid only when you get paid.

That is the pitch. Everything else in this document is what happens after they say "tell me more."

2. What actually happened (so you can explain it)

- Feb 2025: the US put a 25% tariff on Canadian goods that didn't qualify under CUSMA (35% from Aug 2025). Most Canadian exporters had never bothered to qualify because the old rate was already zero — only 38% claimed CUSMA in 2024. So in spring 2025 roughly half of Canadian exports paid the tariff.
- Feb 20 2026: the US Supreme Court ruled those tariffs (imposed under a law called IEEPA) were unlawful. Collection stopped Feb 24. The trade court then ordered the money returned, with interest.
- Apr 20 2026: US Customs (CBP) opened a portal called CAPE inside its ACE system. Refund claims are a file of entry numbers, filed by the importer of record or the customs broker that filed the original entries. Nothing else is required in the file.
- Not refundable: Section 232 tariffs (steel, aluminium, copper, autos, lumber), Section 301, and the new Section 338 tariffs. Only IEEPA.

- Canada's side: Canada charged its own surtaxes on US goods from March 2025 (new 15/25/50% rates from Sept 8 2026). Those are recoverable through remission, duties relief and drawback where the rules are met — a two-year window from import.

3. Who is owed money — the four buckets

Bucket	Who they are	Why they're owed
A. Canadian exporter as importer of record	Shipped DDP / delivered-duty-paid to US customers, or sold through their own US company	They were the 'importer of record' on US Customs paperwork (box 30 of Form 7501), so the refund goes to them
B. The exporter's US customers	US companies that bought from a Canadian supplier and cleared the goods themselves	They paid the tariff; most mid-size ones never registered. The Canadian supplier is our introduction
C. Canadian importers of US goods	Any Canadian company that bought US machinery, parts, inputs since March 2025	Paid Canadian surtax; remission / drawback / refund available in specific circumstances
D. Exporters still paying today	Anyone whose goods don't qualify under CUSMA now	Paying 10% Section 301 today; origin certification stops it (recurring service)

Bucket B is the multiplier. Every Canadian exporter has 5-50 US customers who paid 35% on its goods. "We can get your customers their money back" is the best call a Canadian supplier can make in 2026, and it's how a company hit by the September import bans keeps that customer.

4. Who to call first — the ideal client

- BC or Alberta manufacturer exporting to the US: furniture, food and beverage, packaging, building products, machinery and equipment, plastics, sporting goods, apparel. NOT steel, aluminium, autos or lumber (those tariffs stand).
- Shipped to the US between Feb 2025 and Feb 2026, especially Feb-Jul 2025 (that's when most Canadians were still paying).
- Ships DDP, or has a US warehouse / subsidiary, or has customers who cleared the goods (bucket B).
- US-bound sales of at least US\$1M in that window. Rule of thumb: refund exposure $\approx$ US sales in the window $\times$ share not CUSMA-qualified $\times$ 25-35%. \$2M non-qualified sales at 35% = \$700k.
- Minimum engagement: about \$150k of likely exposure. Below that, only if it opens a bigger door (their customers, or a metals/equipment relationship).

5. What we need from them (and what we never ask for)

We need	Why it's not sensitive
A signed one-page	Lets our partner broker pull their entry data. Standard in the

We need

Why it's not sensitive

authorization + our NDA

industry.

Their customs broker's name and a copy of the broker's entry report (or ACE access)

It's customs data they already gave the broker and CBP: entry numbers, dates, HS codes, values. No financials, no customer prices.

For Canadian surtax: their B3 accounting documents and, for remission, evidence there was no Canadian supplier

Also held by their broker. Remission is the only claim that needs a story; we write it with them.

For origin certification: a bill of materials per product

Same thing they'd hand a lawyer.

We never ask for financial statements, contracts, or customer lists. If a prospect asks "why would I send you my data?", the answer is: you don't. You sign one page, your broker sends the entry report, we work from that.

6. Fees — say them plainly

Work	Fee	When it applies
Simple US refund (Phase 1: entries still open or recently closed)	10% of refund	Their own broker could file this; we charge for finding it, checking it, and chasing it to the bank
Complex US refund (protests, entries past the window, reconciliation, stuck bank setup)	20-25% of refund	This is real work with deadlines; most SME claims land here
Canadian surtax remission / drawback	20-30% of recovery	Evidence-heavy; we build the file
CUSMA origin certification	per product, quoted (rough C\$500-1,500) or monthly retainer	Recurring; stops the 10% today and the 40% transshipment penalty risk
Referral to a claims purchaser (cash now at a discount)	referral fee from purchaser	Only if the client asks for cash before the refund lands

Contingency means: no refund, no fee. We invoice when their money arrives. We do not charge retainers on refunds. Never negotiate below 10% — walk away instead; the time is the same.

7. The process, start to finish

1. Qualify on the call (section 8). Log the answers in the CRM the same day.
2. Send the engagement letter and authorization (templates CM-EL-001, CM-AU-001). Signed = client.
3. Client tells their broker to release the entry report to us, or gives ACE access. Our partner broker pulls the entry list with liquidation dates.
4. The desk builds the claim: which entries carry IEEPA duty (Chapter 99 numbers), which phase they fall in, what deadlines apply, how much is owed. Client gets a one-page findings sheet within 5 business days of data.
5. Client confirms ACE account and bank (ACH) enrolment — the #1 reason approved refunds don't get paid. We walk them through it.
6. Partner broker files the CAPE declaration and/or protests. Desk tracks status weekly and reports monthly.
7. Refund lands (CBP says 60-90 days after acceptance; tell clients 'quarters, not weeks'). We invoice. Then we ask for their US customers' names (bucket B) and start the origin work (bucket D).

8. The qualifying call — script

Open (20 seconds):

Hi, this is [name] from Corridor Metals in Maple Ridge. We help Canadian manufacturers recover US tariffs the Supreme Court struck down this year. Quick question — did you ship anything to the States between February of last year and this February?

If yes, ask these five, in order, and write down the answers:

8. "Roughly how much did you ship to the US in that window?" (looking for \$1M+)
9. "Were your goods claimed under CUSMA at the border, or did you pay the 25 or 35 percent?" (if they don't know: "Who's your customs broker? They'll know in five minutes.")
10. "On the US side, were you the importer of record — do you ship delivered-duty-paid, or do your customers clear it?" (them = bucket A; customers = bucket B)
11. "Have you or your broker already filed a refund claim in CBP's CAPE system?" (if yes, ask if every entry went in and whether the money arrived; 'filed' ≠ 'paid')
12. "Have you bought any US equipment or materials since March 2025 and paid Canadian surtax on it?" (bucket C)

Close:

Based on that, you're likely looking at somewhere between [X] and [Y]. Some of these have deadlines that are already running, so I'd like to get your broker's entry report this week. We only get paid when you do. Can I send you a one-page authorization today?

Never quote a refund figure as a promise. Say "likely", "in the range of", "subject to what the entries show".

9. Objections and the honest answers

They say	We say
"My broker already handled it."	"Great — did every entry go in, including the older ones that needed a protest, and has the money landed? Half the approved refunds are sitting unpaid because the bank setup in ACE isn't done. We'll check for free; if it's all done, we'll tell you."
"Why would I send you my data?"	"You don't. You sign one page; your broker sends us the customs entry report — the same data CBP already has. No financials."
"20% is a lot."	"For the simple ones it's 10%. The 20-25% is for entries that need protests and deadline work — money you otherwise won't see. And it's zero if nothing comes back."
"Is this real? Sounds like a scam."	"It's a Supreme Court ruling and a CBP portal called CAPE — search either. We're local, you can come see us, and you never pay us before you're paid."
"We claimed CUSMA, we didn't pay."	"Then you're in good shape on that side. Two questions: did you buy any US equipment and pay Canadian surtax? And do you have US customers who paid tariffs on your goods? That's where the money is for you."
"How long?"	"CBP says 60-90 days after a claim is accepted. Plan on quarters, not weeks. We report monthly."
"Can you guarantee it?"	"No. Nobody honest can. We can tell you within a week what the entries show and what the rules say, and we only charge on money that arrives."

10. Things a salesperson never says

- "Guaranteed", "you'll definitely get", any specific dollar figure before the desk has seen the entries.
- Anything about legal advice. We prepare and coordinate; licensed brokers file; lawyers handle appeals.
- "All tariffs are refundable." Only IEEPA. Steel, aluminium, autos, lumber, 301 and 338 are not.
- Promises about timing. CBP's own estimate is 60-90 days after acceptance and nobody believes it.
- Bad-mouthing their broker. The broker is our filing partner or our next referral source.

11. Why we run a trial first

PK asked whether we can skip a small trial and go straight to large clients. No. Three reasons, none of them about courage:

- The claim we make on the phone is 'we've done this.' Until one refund has landed in a client's account with our name on the cover letter, that claim isn't backed. One completed file is worth more than any deck.

- The process has moving parts we haven't touched yet: a partner broker's ACE linkage, the Phase 1 vs protest split, ACH enrolment, CBP's validation rejections. We learn those on a \$150-300k claim, not a \$3M one.
- Large clients have advisers. They will ask for a reference. The trial is the reference.

Trial profile: one BC exporter, US\$150-400k exposure, clean broker records, willing to be a reference. Fee at the standard rate — a discount tells them it's a test. Target: engagement signed by Oct 2, findings sheet by Oct 9, first filing by Oct 16. Then the large-client list.

12. Targets — building the list

There is no public list of who paid IEEPA duties. The list is built, not bought, from three sources and qualified by phone:

- Industry directories for the export-heavy sectors above: BC Food & Beverage, BC Wood, Canadian Manufacturers & Exporters (BC), the Alberta and BC chambers' export directories, EDC's exporter lists, Trade Commissioner sector lists.
- Trade data: ImportGenius / Panjiva show US ocean shipments by shipper — useful for larger BC exporters shipping by sea; truck shipments (most of Canada-US) are not public. Volza's US import data shows some Canadian shippers.
- The field: every yard, mill and shop we visit for metals is asked the five questions. Every client is asked for its US customers.

First 20 names: drafted by the desk from the directories above, each with a one-line hook, and marked unqualified until the call. The list lives in the CRM, not in this document, because it changes daily.

13. Numbers you can quote

Fact	Source
US\$166B of IEEPA duties paid by ~330,000 importers, Feb 4 2025 - Feb 24 2026	CBP / trade court filings
~56,000 importers registered as of April 2026, covering \$127B; ~\$39B and ~270,000 importers unregistered	CBP, April 2026
Phase 1 of CAPE covers ~63% of entries; the rest need protests or later phases	CBP / brokers, 2026
Only 38% of Canadian exports claimed CUSMA in 2024; 33% Feb 2025; 50% Mar; 81% by Jul 2025	US Census via RBC; Fitch
Non-CUSMA Canadian goods paid 25% (Feb-Jul 2025) then 35% (Aug 2025-Feb 2026)	US executive orders
Refunds are paid with interest	CIT orders; CBP
Canadian surtax refund window: 2 years from importation; drawback and duties relief available	CBSA Customs Notices 25-19, 26-23

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